Music in Western Civilization

Topic 8.2
The Music of Russia II

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Russian Musical Styles

- Powerful string tones,
- Blasting brass sounds,
- Military use of percussions,
- Scenes of wilderness and cold darkness,
- Endless snow scenes,
- Melodies of deep emotions,
- Symphonies and Ballet 芭蕾

Ballet 芭蕾 : originated from the Italian Renaissance in the 15th century soon developed quickly in France and Russia, later spread to England, USA, Australia, Canada and Asia. King Louis XIV (King of France1643-1715) established the *Royal Dance Academy* in 1661 and started to certify dance instructors.

Paris Opera Ballet 1669-

Mariinsky Ballet, St. Petersburg 1740-

Bolshoi Ballet, Moscow 1776-

Royal Ballet, London, 1931-

American Ballet Theatre, 1939-

National Ballet of Canada, Toronto, 1951

National Ballet of China, Beijing, 1959-

Australian Ballet, 1962-

Shanghai Ballet 1966-

Hong Kong Ballet 1979-





Tchaikovsky: Ballet Music

- Choreographer 编舞 and composer
- Mariinsky Theatre (1860-), St. Petersburg: Mariinsky Ballet (1740-), Mariinsky Opera. Renamed Kirov Ballet during USSR.

- *Swan Lake* 天鹅湖 *1875-76*
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9rJoB7y6Ncs Kirov Ballet. Swan theme 27'18"

- *Nutcracker* 胡桃夹子: *March* *1892*
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lfCSlE2tQco

- *Sleeping Beauty* 睡美人 *1889*
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EDFlRq5RnbQ

Aram **Khachaturian**哈察都量(1903-1978 Soviet Armenian

- Ballet: Gayane Suite No.3: *Sabre Dance*.
- Rattle · Berliner Philharmoniker
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mUQHGpxrz-8

Nicolai **Rimsky-Korsakov** 林姆斯基-高沙可夫 1844-1908

- *Scheherazade*, Op.35 symphonic suite of 4 movements
- a story from *One Thousand and One Nights*, a collection of folk stories written in Arabic in 8th-14th century, English-language edition came in 1706–1721.
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=obPucSY6sig

- Movement II: beautiful violin solo to begin
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QhV78zLt3KE

- choreography, choreographer编舞家

Igor **Stravinsky** 史特拉汶斯基

1882-1971

Resided in Russia, then 1920-39 in France, 1939-71 in USA

Ballet music

Le Sacre du printemps / The Rite of Spring 春之祭,

Written in 1913 for Ballets Russes, premiered at the Théâtre des Champs-Elysées in Paris on 29 May 1913 and caused a riot

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NQQR-GU14sQ Gergiev.

Starts from 4'33" bassoon solo

Russian folklore, Primitivism, Neo-classicism

Sergei **Rachmaninoff** 拉赫曼尼诺夫1873-1943

- *Prelude for Piano in G minor, 1901*
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mxnL7UrkmY4 Kissin

- Exciting rhythm and rhapsodic style

- *Rhapsody On A Theme Of Paganini*, Op.43, 1934.
- *24 variations*
- *Variation 18*
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ThTU04p3drM
- Most beloved movie music, used in over 10 movies including *Somewhere in Time*

Dmitri **Shostakovich** 肖斯塔科维奇 1906-1975

- 15 Symphonies
- Symphony No. 2, (*To October),* Op.14 (1927)
- Symphony No. 3 in E-flat major (*First of May*), Op. 20 (1930)
- Symphony No.7 in C major (*Leningrad),* Op. 60 *(1941)*
- Symphony No.11 in G minor, (*The Year 1905)*, Op.103 (1957)
- Symphony No.12 in D minor, (*The Year 1917),* Op.112 (1961)

- *Symphony No.5 in D minor*, op.47, 1937,
- 4th movement
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xU9_uAb7pZs beginning and from 7' 15" till the end to appreciate the building up of the climax to end. Note the powerful brasses and timpani

- Thank you in Russian = Spasiba

- 0:30
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lbhhnu-UoyM